



ROUTEUP CAREER GUIDANCE SERIES — VOLUME 8

Getting Your First Job Abroad

The Method That Beats Mass Applications

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Why Educated Migrants End Up in Survival Jobs

In every destination city there are master's degree holders driving deliveries. Not because jobs don't exist — because the job search methods that work in India fail abroad, and nobody corrected them. This volume is the correction.

Myth: “Someone from my community will refer me.”

Reality: 'My brother is there, my friend will help' is the weakest strategy in existence. References help at the margin; they do not replace a fit profile and a proper application. The people who wait for referrals are the ones still waiting.

Myth: “LinkedIn cold messages work if I send enough.”

Reality: Recruiters receive hundreds of copy-paste messages and recognise them instantly. Mass cold outreach mostly earns silence and occasionally a block. Connections matter — real ones, built through genuine engagement, not collection requests.

Myth: “Applying to every opening maximises my chances.”

Reality: As an international candidate your CV passes through stricter multi-stage screening than local applicants. A hundred generic applications produce a hundred first-round rejections. Ten targeted, tailored applications produce interviews.

The Direct Method

- **1. Choose narrowly:** Pick roles that match BOTH your academics and your work history — the straight line again. Screening software and humans both reject profile-role mismatches first.
- **2. Research the company, not just the vacancy:** Study the organisation. Find the hiring manager or named recruiter — team pages, the job posting, the company website.
- **3. Email the person who actually hires:** Short, personalised email to that named person: who you are in one line, why THIS role and company in two, tailored CV attached. This single habit outperforms fifty portal applications.
- **4. Rebuild your CV for the local market:** Local format, one to two pages, achievements with numbers, adapted keywords per role. Your Indian CV format will be screened out on sight in most markets.
- **5. Build local evidence:** Internships, apprenticeships, volunteer roles and part-time work IN YOUR FIELD beat unrelated survival work on a CV. Take survival work if needed — but never stop the field-specific search.

The four-stage pipeline to expect

CV screen → recruiter call → technical/competency interview → final round. International applicants rarely skip stages. Prepare for each specifically: the CV gets you stage two; your spoken clarity gets you stage three; your prepared examples get you stage four.

What consultancies won't tell you: legitimate employers never charge candidates. Any 'placement agency' demanding money for interviews, 'CV activation', or 'client introductions' — and any online contact offering a job you never applied for — is running a scam. Real recruitment pays the recruiter from the employer's side, always.

Worksheet — My Job Search System

☐ My target role titles (max 3): _____

☐ 10 target companies that hire this role in my city:

- ☐ Named hiring manager / recruiter found for the first 3:

 - ☐ My CV is rebuilt in local format, with quantified achievements
 - ☐ I have a tailored email draft — not a template blast
 - ☐ My weekly targets: ____ researched companies, ____ personalised applications, ____ follow-ups
 - ☐ I am building field-specific local evidence (internship/volunteer/projects), not only survival work
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When to Get Help

Everything in this volume you can act on yourself — that is deliberate. But the worksheet you just filled has answers only YOU could write, and validating those answers against real requirements, real budgets, and real immigration rules is where mistakes hide.

Bring your completed job search system to session with RouteUp. We will go through it line by line and tell you honestly — including if your plan is fine and you don't need us further.

Book your free session: routeup.co.in · hello@routeup.co.in ·

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